

Paper #2

Case Study Analysis: Yes Bank - AI or Human Connection for Talent Management?

HRM6035 Digital HR Platforms

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CASE SUMMARY

The Yes Bank case study by Mukherji and Bhatnagar (2021) explores the challenges and opportunities faced by the bank as it seeks to integrate AI and machine learning technologies into its talent acquisition and management processes. In a competitive banking landscape shaped by digital disruption, Yes Bank partnered with Talocity, an AI-based hiring platform, to enhance efficiency in screening and selecting candidates. The bank's strategic vision focused on agile hiring, operational efficiency, and positioning itself as a tech-savvy employer of choice. However, this initiative raised critical questions: Could AI truly replace human connection in hiring? How could technology be balanced with the personal touch required for organizational culture fit and candidate experience? The case brings to light the broader dilemmas faced by modern organizations that are transforming traditional HR functions through digital tools.

PROBLEMS

The core issue revolves around whether Yes Bank can rely solely on AI to drive talent acquisition without compromising the human connection critical to long-term employee success and cultural alignment. Specific problems include:

- **Loss of human touch in hiring:** Automated interviews and AI-driven assessments risk alienating candidates by creating a sterile experience.
- **Potential bias in AI algorithms:** Concerns arise over ethical hiring practices, fairness, and explainability of AI decisions.
- **Resistance from internal stakeholders:** Recruiters and hiring managers may lack trust or understanding of AI tools, which can hinder adoption.

- **Lack of personal judgment:** AI may fail to capture non-verbal cues, nuanced personality traits, and cultural fit—important for service-driven industries like banking.

SOLUTIONS

Yes Bank needs to adopt a balanced, hybrid strategy that uses AI for administrative efficiency while preserving human involvement where strategic, emotional, and cultural judgment is essential. Key solutions include:

- **Hybrid AI-Human Model:** Automate repetitive tasks like resume screening and scheduling while keeping interviews and final decisions human-led.
- **Ethical AI Integration:** Regular audits to eliminate bias, ensure fairness, and foster trust in AI.
- **Recruiter Upskilling:** Equip TA teams with digital fluency and emotional intelligence training.
- **Candidate Experience Design:** Personalize recruitment journeys using AI-enabled insights, combined with genuine human outreach.
- **Talent Intelligence Systems:** Integrate AI tools with existing HRIS to offer predictive insights for proactive workforce planning.

RECOMMENDATIONS

To resolve the central dilemma at Yes Bank—balancing AI-driven efficiency with human-centric engagement in talent management—I recommend a multi-pronged, strategic hybrid model with the following components:

1. **Design a Human-in-the-Loop AI Hiring Model** Yes Bank should operationalize an

administrative and analytical tasks while humans remain central to value-based decision-making. AI handles initial résumé parsing, skill-based matching, personality assessments, and scheduling (Waddill, 2022; Stone et al., 2020). Humans lead cultural fit interviews, final decision-making, and candidate engagement. This model improves time-to-fill and hiring costs while enhancing person-organization fit (Ulrich et al., 2019).

- 2. Implement AI Bias Audits and Ethical AI Governance** Talocity and similar platforms must undergo continuous auditing for algorithmic bias, particularly around gender, age, and education. Regular fairness and accuracy checks, Explainable AI protocols, and the formation of a Digital Ethics Committee will ensure ethical deployment (Boudreau & Rice, 2020).
- 3. Re-skill TA Teams for Digital-Human Synergy** Recruiters must evolve from resume reviewers to relationship architects. Invest in microlearning and coaching on AI tools, ethics, and digital sourcing techniques. This increases recruiter confidence and ensures consistent tool application (Sahni & Bhatnagar, 2021).
- 4. Curate Personalized Candidate Journeys** Technology should augment, not replace, human engagement. Use AI to deliver personalized role previews and real-time recruiter interactions. Introducing candidate experience KPIs (e.g., Net Promoter Score, response time) will help maintain a people-first experience (Ulrich et al., 2019).
- 5. Develop a Digital Talent Intelligence System** Combine Talocity with Yes Bank's HRIS to build a talent intelligence platform that supports both real-time and predictive workforce planning. This includes flight risk prediction, internal mobility tracking,

and external benchmarking (Waddill, 2022).

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6. Strategic Sourcing through Digital Branding and Partnerships Strengthen the employer brand by targeting tech-savvy candidates through social media, ed-tech partnerships, and virtual recruitment events. AI can assist in sourcing passive candidates while human engagement maintains authenticity (Stone et al., 2020).

These recommendations position HR as a strategic partner and promote both efficiency and empathy in talent acquisition.

CONCLUSION

Yes Bank stands at a crossroads where it must harness the power of AI without compromising the human connection that defines strong workplace culture and engagement. Implementing a hybrid AI-Human talent acquisition model provides both scalability and personalization, while AI bias audits and recruiter training build ethical and sustainable practices. The plan's success depends on stakeholder alignment, transparent governance, and iterative improvements based on data-driven insights. Should unanticipated outcomes arise, contingency strategies such as reverting to traditional hiring for executive roles or piloting AI tools departmentally will provide controlled adaptability.

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